

ENTREPRENEURIAL PULSE



E-club APIIT

apiit_eclub



THE ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING



A new dawn, a new beginning! The second Annual General Meeting of the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT took place on the 4th of December 2023 and marked a momentous occasion for the new dawn, a new beginning! The second Annual General Meeting of the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT took place on the 4th of December 2023 and marked a momentous occasion for the club as it embarked on its second year of remarkable success. The outgoing committee, led by President Tehzeeb Bishri bid farewell to a journey of ups and downs, building the club from the bottom, and creating strong foundations for it to stand on.

The Annual General Meeting commenced with the signatory lighting of the oil lamp, a testament to our proud culture, with various esteemed individuals gracing the occasion, from the chairman of APIIT Sri Lanka, Mr Bandula Egodage, Head of APIIT Business School, Doctor Hasuli Perera, Head of APIIT Law School, Dr Chathura Warnasuriya, Head of APIIT Computing School, Mr Gamindu and all club patrons.



Taking place at the Auditorium on City Campus Premises, the memorable ceremony saw a spectacle of various speeches, recollections and a flurry of emotions. From a prideful speech from the chairman as well as club patron, Mr Vihanga Jayasinghe, to a vivid recollection of the events and projects the club undertook, delivered by outgoing President Tehzeeb Bishri and Treasurer Thilhara Thenuwara to an inspirational speech by incoming President Vidussh Gunasekera, it truly was a day of legacy for the Entrepreneurship Club.



As with all joyous occasions, the second Annual General Meeting concluded with the badging ceremony of the current committee as well as a farewell to the outgoing committee followed by refreshments and happy interactions. As the E-Club now embarks on another year of momentous and triumphant projects, we welcome all E-Club members to actively engage and interact to be groomed as future leaders!



Following experience sharing and inspirational addresses from both Chief Guests, the event moved to its signature piece- a panel discussion titled "Girls in Power : APIIT Club Edition" where representatives from some of the major APIIT Clubs were present. The panelists were Ms. Shiranaaz Kaney, Ms. Yanika Amarasekera, Ms. Vithara Mannage (Lecturer), Amanyak Ekanayake (E-Club Vice President), Sharthvikaa Ananthkumar (Vice President, Social - SAC), Samaa Shazuli (Editor in Chief of The Catalyst), Suhayla Ralick (Editor of Rotaract) and Runeesha Senadeera (Events Manager of FCS).



It was truly an one of a kind event, and was successfully concluded with tokens of appreciation.

PROJECT HERSTORY



IN

commemoration of International Women's Day, the Entrepreneurship Club held Project HerStory, a project aimed at celebrating and empowering all the women in our lives. Chaired by

Vice President Amanyak Ekanayake and Events Lead Madhumitha Balajayendhan, Project HerStory took place on the 15th of March 2024 at the School of Foundation; APIIT's newest facility. Coincidentally, the Entrepreneurship Club was the first club at APIIT to host an event at the new facility. The main guests of honour for the event were Ms. Shiranaaz Kaney, Chief Operating Office of Clootrack Software Labs and Ms. Yanika Amarasekera, Founder and Chief Operating Officer of Silver Aisle,

INNOVATE X



TO

align with one of the key themes of the Entrepreneurship Club for the year 2024, Creativity and Innovation, the initiative was undertaken to organize an experience sharing session and workshop that would enable students to understand the importance of embracing creativity and innovation as entrepreneurs and in the corporate world. The key entrepreneur for the project was famed national swimmer and entrepreneur Mr. Cherantha De Silva.

Innovate X, which was chaired by President Vidussh Gunasekera, took place on the 20th of March 2024 at the School of Foundation, Access Towers II from 4PM onwards with Mr. Cherantha De Silva taking attendees through his journey of being a young entrepreneur with tips on tackling obstacles faced in the Sri Lankan business environment, especially by young entrepreneurs. The token of appreciation was handed over by Doctor Hasuli Perera.



STUDENT ENTREPRENEUR

SPOTLIGHT: KAVINDU WANNISINGHE

1. What sparked your entrepreneurial spirit? How did you come up with your business idea?

My passion for storytelling truly ignited in 2016 when I acquired my first camera. Experimenting with it, I discovered the magic of capturing stories through the lens. After years of experience and an unwavering love for the creative field, I felt compelled to take the leap and turn my passion into a venture. The idea for Black Canvas LK stemmed from wanting to use event photography as a platform to showcase narratives, emotions, and the unique essence of gatherings.

2. What have been the biggest challenges you've faced so far? What have you learned the most from these experiences?

One of the biggest hurdles has been balancing my studies with running Black Canvas LK. It requires meticulous time management and prioritizing tasks effectively. This journey has taught me the importance of staying organized, resilient, and adaptable. I've also learned to embrace the continuous learning curve that comes with being an entrepreneur.

3. Why do you prefer running your own venture?

The freedom and creativity involved in running Black Canvas LK are incredibly fulfilling. I enjoy collaborating with clients and turning their visions into reality through my lens. Being my own boss allows me to steer the business in a direction that aligns with my values and creative vision.



4. How do you balance your studies with running your business? Do you have any time management tips for other student entrepreneurs?

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5. What resources have been most helpful to you as a student entrepreneur?

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6. How are you marketing your business and reaching your target audience? What strategies have been most effective?

Building an online presence through social media platforms like Instagram and Facebook has been key. Engaging content, networking with event planners and vendors, and offering referral programs have proven effective in reaching my target audience.

7. What impact do you hope your business will have? Where do you see your business in 5-10 years?

I hope Black Canvas LK goes beyond capturing events; I aspire to capture the essence of human connection and emotions that make every gathering unique. In 5-10 years, I envision Black Canvas LK expanding its services and becoming a leading photography company, capturing not just events but also personal stories and memories.



@blackcanvaslk

8. Do you have any mentors or advisors who have supported your journey? What advice would you give to other students seeking mentorship?

I've been fortunate to connect with experienced photographers and entrepreneurs who have offered invaluable guidance and support. My advice to students seeking mentorship is to be proactive, network within your field, and approach individuals whose work and expertise resonate with you.

9. What are your top three pieces of advice for aspiring student entrepreneurs?

1. Passion is key:
Pursue an idea you're genuinely passionate about, as it will fuel your journey through challenges.
2. Embrace continuous learning:
Be open to learning new skills, adapting to evolving trends, and seeking knowledge from experienced individuals.
3. Build a strong network:
Connect with fellow student entrepreneurs, mentors, and individuals in your field for support and guidance.



10. What keeps you motivated and inspired?

Witnessing the joy and appreciation on my clients' faces when they see their captured memories is incredibly rewarding. The creative freedom and opportunity to turn my passion into a profession are constant sources of motivation.

11. Looking back, would you do anything differently? What have you enjoyed most about your entrepreneurial journey as a student?

While the journey has been challenging, I wouldn't change a thing. The experiences, lessons learned, and connections formed have been invaluable. The most enriching aspect has been witnessing the positive impact my work has on clients and the creative freedom to express myself through the lens.

PSYCHOLOGY OF ENTREPRENEURSHIP

BY MADHUMITHA BALAJAYENDHAN



*80% of success is
accessed by your
psychology, 20% is in
your actions.*

The psychology of Entrepreneurship relates to understanding the relationship between successful business leadership and the mental strategies and traits that thriving entrepreneurs have. Fortunately, the likelihood of developing a successful business may increase if the individual running it recognizes the significance of specific psychological attributes. An essential factor for future entrepreneurs to take into account is their understanding of human behaviour and how it relates to business.

Moreover, there is a similarity in the ways that entrepreneurs approach their business, despite the fact that each individual has a unique mind. For instance, entrepreneurs are often driven to address a particular issue or close a particular market gap. Additionally, entrepreneurs tend to be confident and independent, and they are not afraid to take calculated risks to place a wager on themselves.



Furthermore, what comes to our mind when we think about achieving success as an entrepreneur? When making decisions to enter the business world, we consider several elements, including finances, leadership, critical thinking, and market trends. But psychology is rarely taken into account as a contributing component and some people might be surprised to learn that psychology can be a key factor in assisting people in becoming a profitable entrepreneur.

In addition, knowing psychology is vital in entrepreneurship as our emotions influence our decisions when it comes to business. This is the reason why startups and multinational corporations invest a significant amount of money in developing interesting digital marketing campaigns as it is critical to comprehend customer psychology in order to handle services and products effectively. Successful entrepreneurs typically possess a thorough understanding of customer psychology. They are aware of the factors that influence consumer decisions, their problems and the best ways to position their goods and services to satisfy those demands.

Additionally, innovative and creative thinking are frequently found in successful entrepreneurs. They are skilled at coming up with creative ways to solve issues because they view challenges as opportunities.

Moreover, a strong sense of passion for what they do motivates many business owners. Their motivation stems from the desire to pursue their interests, create something significant, or have a beneficial influence in the field they have chosen.



Furthermore, successful entrepreneurs typically have a very clear business vision and are very goal-oriented. They have high standards for themselves and strive hard to meet them, but they're also adaptable enough to change course when necessary.

Furthermore, establishing a business can be difficult, and failures are unavoidable. Entrepreneurs must possess resilience and persistence in order to overcome setbacks and failures with determination and hope.

In conclusion, the psychology of entrepreneurship is a complex network of characteristics, actions and, desires that inspire people to take on the demanding yet rewarding task of starting and managing their own businesses. Entrepreneurs have a special mix of psychological traits that make them stand out, from a willingness to take calculated risks and a flair for creativity to determination in the face of adversity and a deep-seated passion for their profession.

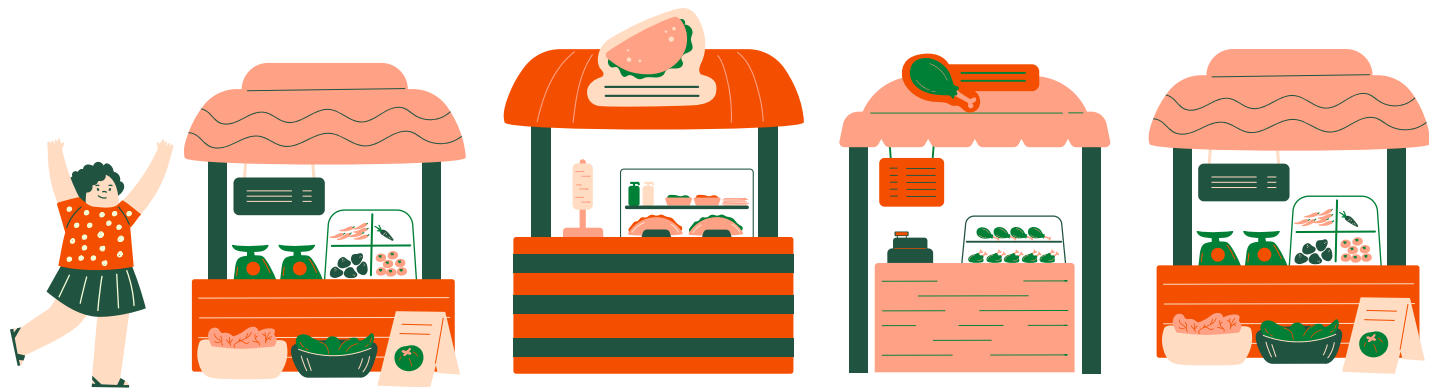


CALLING ALL STUDENT ENTREPRENEURS!

READY TO TAKE YOUR BUSINESS TO THE NEXT LEVEL? VENDOR REGISTRATION IS NOW OPEN FOR OUR UPCOMING FAIRS!

MORE INFORMATION & OPEN BOOTH CONTACT:

DEWDUN: 075 205 5625



ATTENTION WRITERS!



READY TO SPARK INNOVATION?

BEGIN WRITING NOW AND JOIN OUR INAUGURAL NEWSLETTER. LET'S FUEL THE RISE OF TOMORROW'S ENTREPRENEURS!

SUBMIT YOUR WORK TO ECLUB@APIIT.LK

OPEN TO BOTH STUDENTS AND LECTURERS!

